Project Charter Template · Expert version

A project charter template helps you formally authorise a project on one or two pages: why it exists, what it must achieve, what is in and out of scope, who is accountable and who signs it off.

How to use this template

1. Agree the purpose and objectives with the sponsor before writing anything else.
2. Fill in scope and, just as importantly, what is out of scope.
3. Add milestones, budget, top risks, assumptions and constraints.
4. Name the sponsor and project manager and state the project manager's authority.
5. Review it with key stakeholders, then get the sponsor's signature.
6. Store the signed charter with the project management plan and revisit it at major milestones.

Tips

- Keep it to two pages; detail belongs in the project plan.
- Write objectives you can measure at the end.
- List exclusions to prevent scope creep.
- Do not start detailed planning until it is signed.

Project charter · Complete each section and get the sponsor's sign-off

Section	Guidance	Your content
Project name	Short, memorable name used in all communications.	Customer Portal
Purpose / business case	Why the project is needed and the benefits expected.	Reduce account-related support calls by letting customers self-serve.
Objectives (SMART)	Measurable outcomes with dates.	Cut account-related calls by 30% within 6 months of launch.
In scope	What the project will deliver.	Account view, invoices, password reset.
Out of scope	What it will not deliver.	Mobile app; payments.
Key deliverables	Main outputs.	Portal release 1; training guide; support runbook.
Milestones	Major dates.	Design sign-off 15 Feb; Go-live 31 Mar.
Budget	Approved budget or range.	$150,000
Key risks	Top risks known at the start.	Billing system integration delays.
Assumptions and constraints	What you assume to be true and the limits you must work within.	Billing API available by 1 Feb.
Stakeholders	Key people and groups affected.	Customer service, IT, Finance, customers.
Sponsor	Accountable executive.	Head of Customer Service
Project manager and authority	Who leads and what they can decide.	A. Rossi; can approve changes up to $5,000.
Approval	Name, signature and date.	